

Story 4	Escaping the Weekly Report
Story Title	Escaping the Weekly Report
Meta Goal	To shift the learner’s mindset from performing repetitive tasks to designing repeatable, automated processes.
Target Audience	Professionals who perform regular, manual, information-based tasks and feel their time is consumed by low-value work.
Time	8 minutes (Storytelling: 4 min, Workflow Design: 4 min)
Context	AI Literacy, Level 4
Version	
Starting Competence	Conscious Competence (Can use AI to get answers from documents and data for one-off tasks).
Ending Competence	Conscious Incompetence (Understands the “Trigger-Step-Output” model for workflow design but hasn’t yet built or debugged a live automation).
Story Objective	Learners can map a manual business process into a “Trigger-Step-Output” diagram and identify where an AI can be inserted to add value.
Essential Question	Should you be <i>doing</i> the task, or should you be <i>designing the machine</i> that does the task?
Anchor Question	“That report you spend an hour on every Friday... what if it just did itself? What would you do with that hour?”
Story Arc	Setup: We are now powerful analysts who can interrogate documents (L2) and data (L3). But we’re still doing it all by hand, one task at a time. It’s exhausting. Tension: The visceral pain of a repetitive, low-value, deadline-driven task is presented (the “4 PM Friday report”). We feel the dread and boredom. Disruption: The introduction of the “workflow engineer” mindset. We stop seeing the task as something to <i>do</i>, and start seeing it as a process to <i>design</i>. The “Trigger-Step-Output” model provides a simple language for this. Insight: My value isn’t in manually copying data. It’s in designing a system that does it for me. I can use AI not just as an analyst, but as a component <i>inside</i> a workflow I design.
Teaching Tools	Slide visuals (The “Agony” of the manual report vs. the clean “Trigger-Step-Output” diagram), Whiteboard/Digital collaboration space for the exercise.

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Teaching Situation Full group lecture, followed by a pen-and-paper individual exercise to map a personal workflow.

Tension & Friction The realization that to automate a process, you must first understand it perfectly. The friction comes from trying to write down the steps of a task they do on “autopilot,” often revealing hidden complexities.

Exercise Hook “We all have a ‘weekly report’ in our lives. A task that drains our will to live. I want you to pick one. On the worksheet, we’re going to map it. What’s the trigger? What are the exact steps you take? What’s the final output? And where could an AI do one of those steps for you?”

Teaching Core The “aha!” moment when a learner successfully diagrams their own manual workflow and sees, for the first time, how it could be a machine. They experience the cognitive shift from “doer” to “designer” on paper, which is the necessary prerequisite for doing it with actual tools.
